The SDGs in My Community

SDG 11 - Sustainable Cities and Communities

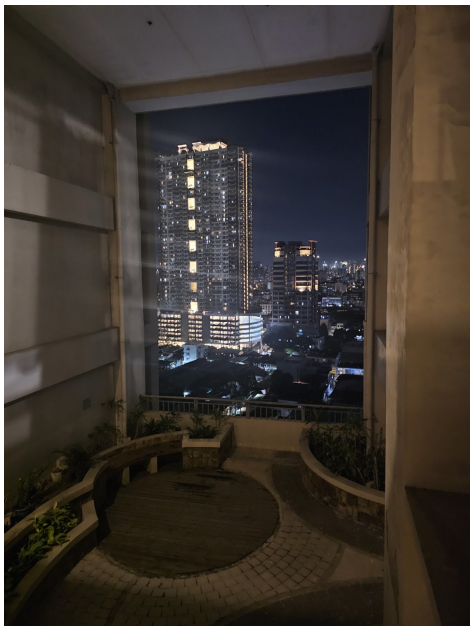


Photo 1 - Green Space

This photo shows one of the small garden areas in our condo. I usually just walk past this place and never really think much about it. After doing this activity I realized that having green spaces like this is actually important especially when you live in the city. It gives residents a place where they can enjoy some greenery even when we are surrounded by buildings.



Photo 2 - Recycling

This photo shows a recycling bin for used beverage cartons in our condo. I see things like this often but I never really paid attention to their purpose before. It gives residents a place where they can properly throw recyclable materials instead of mixing them with regular trash. I think simple things like this can help keep our community cleaner as long as people actually use them properly.



Photo 3 - Pedestrian Safety

This photo shows the pedestrian lanes around our condo. There are cars passing through this area every day so these lanes give people a safer place to walk and cross. At first I did not really think this had anything to do with SDG 11. But I realized that having a sustainable community also means making it safe and convenient for the people living there.

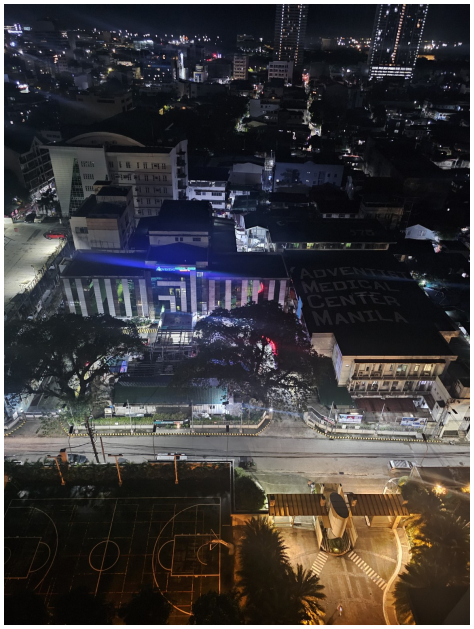


Photo 4 - Nearby Hospital

This photo shows Adventist Medical Center Manila which is just across the road from our condo. I have always known that the hospital was there but I never really thought about how useful it is to have one this close. If someone needs medical attention they do not have to travel very far. Having important places like a hospital nearby is one of the things that can make a community easier and safer to live in.



Photo 5 - My Community

I took this selfie while walking around our condo for this activity. Most of the places and things I photographed are stuff that I see almost every day. I just never really stopped to think about why they were there or how they helped our community. Doing this made me notice things around my home that I normally would not even think twice about.

Reflection

Before doing this activity I thought sustainable development was mostly about the environment. I thought of things like planting trees or reducing pollution. I also thought it was mostly something that governments or big organizations worked on. After walking around my own community I realized that it can actually be seen in a lot of normal things around us.

The garden was probably the most obvious example for me because it gives us some greenery even though we live in the city. The recycling bin also showed me how residents are given a way to manage some of their waste properly. But what surprised me was realizing that the pedestrian lanes and the nearby hospital can also be connected to a sustainable community. It is not just about being environmentally friendly. A community should also be safe and convenient for the people living there.

I also realized that these things will not really work if the residents themselves do not care about them. We can have recycling bins but they are useless if nobody uses them properly. The same goes for keeping our gardens and shared areas clean. Ordinary people can help by doing simple things like throwing trash properly and following community rules. After doing this activity I learned that helping achieve SDG 11 does not always have to be something big. Even small actions can matter when everyone in the community does their part.